Rex Weiye Deng

Division of Social Science
New York University Abu Dhabi
Saadiyat Island
Abu Dhabi, U.A.E

weiye.deng@nyu.edu
rexweiyedeng.org
LinkedIn: rex-weiye-deng
Twitter: @rexhere1

Employment

New York University Abu Dhabi, Abu Dhabi, U.A.E.
Assistant Professor of Political Science, 2026–

Education

Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, Missouri, U.S.A.
Ph.D., Political Science, 2026
- *Dissertation: Turning Resistance into Compliance: The Art of Transforming Negative Public Opinion*

M.A., Political Science, 2023

Waseda University, Tokyo, Japan
B.A., Economics, 2020

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong SAR, China
B.Sc. (First-Class Honors), Global China Studies, 2020

Research Interests

Comparative Politics: Authoritarian Politics, Political Communication, China
International Relations: Public Diplomacy, International Cooperation, U.S.–China relations
Methodology: Computational Methods, Surveys, Experiments

Publications

"Propaganda of Democracy's Flaws and Its Impact on Regime Evaluations in Autocracies." *The Journal of Politics*.

Working Papers

"Screened Realities: How Entertainment Fosters Political Compliance in Autocracies." Conditionally Accepted, *American Political Science Review*.
- Supported by the *APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant (DDRIG)*
- Winner of the *Pi Sigma Alpha Best Paper by a Graduate Student Award*, MPSA 2025
- Winner of the *Rebecca Morton Poster Award*, 2025 Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science
- Winner of the *Timothy E. Cook Best Graduate Student Paper Award*, APSA 2024

"Exploiting Extremism: Strategic Responses of Radical Right Parties to Right-Wing Violence in Europe" (with Taishi Muraoka and Margit Tavits). Revise and Resubmit.

"Softening the Crisis: How Cultural Diplomacy Fosters Interstate Reconciliation."

"How Do State-Led Infrastructure Projects Affect Trust in Historically Hard-to-Reach Places?" (with David Carter). Under review.

"Can Leaders Shape Public Opinion During a Foreign Policy Crisis? Evidence from U.S. Withdrawal from Afghanistan" (with Amaan Charaniya, Dahjin Kim, Gechun Lin, William Nomikos, and İpek Ece Şener). Under review.

- *Best Paper Award for the Foreign Policy Section*, APSA 2022

Work in Progress

"The Blessing and Curse of Cute Propaganda" (with Haifeng Huang).

"Turning Crisis into Opportunities: How Authoritarian Regimes Appeal to Mass Emotions in Crisis Communication" (with Xiaoxiao Shen).

"Singing the Truth: Correcting Misperceptions Through Song Lyrics" (with Dahjin Kim).

"Imperial Echoes: How Historical Dramas Shape Contemporary Support for Strongman Rule."

Honors & Grants

Awards

Provost's Award for Graduate Research Excellence 2025
- University-level recognition for outstanding scholarly achievement, creativity, and independent research as a doctoral student (WashU)

Dean's Award for Graduate Research Excellence (Semifinalist) 2025
- School-level recognition of outstanding research and scholarly accomplishments prior to graduation (WashU)

School of Political Science and Economics Award 2019
- Awarded for the first Waseda Data Science Competition
- Theme: Predict results of Japan's Upper House Election in 2019
- With Wenhao (Brian) Jiang, Yuji Mizushima, and Siyuan Shang

Dean's List, The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology 2016–2018

Research Grants

Governance and Public Policy Cluster Conference Grant, NYUAD ($20,000). 2026
- Co-PI: Leonid Peisakhin

Governance and Public Policy Cluster Research Grant, NYUAD ($4,967). 2026
- Co-PI: Peng Peng

Computational Social Science Cluster Research Grant, NYUAD ($4,500). 2026
- Co-PI: Frank Xu

URC-Halle Institute Global Research Award, Emory University ($30,000) 2026
- Co-PI: Tony Zirui Yang, Kuan Liu, and Leo Tien

APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant ($10,009) 2025

Juniors Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies ($6,000) 2025

Research Grant, Institute for Humane Studies ($16,700) 2024

Dissertation Grant, WashU ($1,000) 2024

Small Research Grant, Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy, WashU ($15,000) 2024
- Co-PI: Margit Tavits and Taishi Muraoka

Small Research Grant, Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy, WashU ($12,000) 2024
- Co-PI: Ted Enamorado

Legislative Studies Quarterly Research Award, Washington University ($5,000) 2020

Travel Grants

APSA DDRIG Travel Grant ($1,000) 2025
PolMeth Travel Award ($1,000) 2025
ISA Travel Grant ($600) 2025
APSA Political Psychology Section Distinguished Junior Scholar Award ($600) 2024
APSA Travel Grant ($200) 2023
APSA Travel Grant ($200); APSA Foreign Policy Section Travel Grant ($500) 2022

Scholarships

Asian Future Leadership Scholarship, Bai Xian Asia Institute (≈ $28,680) 2018
- Full tuition and living expenses for study at Waseda University

Ho & Ho Foundation Scholarship, The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (≈ $76,000) 2015
- Full tuition and living expenses for study at HKUST

Additional Training

Washington University in St. Louis, St. Louis, Missouri

Spatial Statistics (Scott Cook) Summer 2024
Text-As-Data (Brandon Stewart) Summer 2023
Time Series Analysis (Clayton Webb) Summer 2022
Python camp (Benjamin Noble) Summer 2021
Math camp (Jacob Montgomery) Summer 2020

East China University of Political Science and Law, Shanghai, China

Training Camp of Political Methodology and Chinese Political Institution Summer 2020

Presentations

Invited Talks

Duke Kunshan University, Division of Social Science 2026
New York University Abu Dhabi, Division of Social Science 2025
University of Utah, Department of Political Science 2025
University of California, Davis, Department of Political Science 2025

Workshops and Seminars

Political Communication: An Interdisciplinary Dialogue (HKU) 2026
Political Science Speaker Series (Online) 2025
Southwest Workshop on Mixed Methods Research 2025
Authoritarian Political System Group Online Workshop 2025
Frontiers in Political Methodology (WashU) 2025
Virtual Workshops on Authoritarian Regimes 2025
Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science (NYU) 2025
Comparative Politics Annual Conference (WashU) 2023–2025
State Capacity Conference (Yale) 2022
The Politics of State Authority and Insecurity Workshop (Rutgers University) 2022

Annual Meetings of Professional Associations

American Political Science Association (APSA) 2022–2025
International Studies Association (ISA) 2025
The Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth) 2025

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2022–2023, 2025–2026
Western Political Science Association (WPSA)	2023, 2025
Southern Political Science Association (SPSA)	2025
North American Meeting of the Peace Science Society (International)	2024
Asian PolMeth	2027
Eurasian Peace Science Conference	2027
ISA-Midwest	2022

Teaching

Instructor, New York University Abu Dhabi, Division of Social Science

Chinese Politics	Spring 2027
Psychology of War and Peace	Spring 2027

Guest Lectures

Digital Propaganda and Repression (Yingdan Lu, Northwestern)	Fall 2025
Communication Theory (Yuewei Qiu, University of Oklahoma)	Summer 2026

Service

To the discipline

Journal Reviewer, *The Journal of Politics*, *International Studies Quarterly*, *Conflict Management of Peace Science*, *Journal of Chinese Political Science*, *Contemporary Politics*

Committee Chair, Timothy E. Cook Best Graduate Student Paper Award, APSA 2025

To New York University Abu Dhabi

Co-organizer, Conference for MSc in Interdisciplinary Data Science and Artificial Intelligence (MIDSAI) Winter School (with Aaron Kaufman and Ben Rosche) 2027

Nomination Committee Member, Yenching Academy Program (with Doug Cutchins and Jing Chai) 2026

To Washington University in St. Louis

Coordinator, Comparative Politics Annual Conference 2025

Manager, WashU Political Data Science Lab Fall 2022–Fall 2023

Technical Skills

R, Python, Stata, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, Tableau, LaTeX

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (native), Cantonese (native)

English (fluent), Japanese (basic)